

JOHARI'S WINDOW MODEL OF COMMUNICATION

American psychologists Joseph Luft and Harry Ingham developed this model in 1955. The idea was derived as the upshot of the group dynamics in University of California and was later improved by Joseph Luft. The name 'Johari' came from joining their first two names. This model is also denoted as feedback/disclosure model of self-awareness.

The Johari window model is used to enhance the individual's perception on others. This model is based on two ideas- trust can be acquired by revealing information about you to others and learning yourselves from their feedbacks. Each person is represented by the Johari model through four quadrants or window pane. Each four window panes signifies personal information, feelings, motivation and whether that information is known or unknown to oneself or others in four viewpoints.

The Johari Window Model

The method of conveying and accepting feedback is interpreted in this model. A Johari is represented as a common window with four panes. Two of these panes represent self and the other two represent the part unknown to self but to others. The information transfers from one pane to the other as the result of mutual trust which can be achieved through socializing and the feedback got from other members of the group.

1. Open/self-area or arena – Here the information about the person his attitudes, behaviour, emotions, feelings, skills and views will be known by the person as well as by others. This is mainly the area where all the communications occur and the larger the arena becomes the more effectual and dynamic the relationship will be. 'Feedback solicitation' is a process which occurs by understanding and listening to the feedback from another person. Through this way the open area can be increased horizontally decreasing the blind spot. The size of the arena can also be increased downwards and thus by reducing the hidden and unknown areas through revealing one's feelings to other person.

2. Blind self or blind spot – Information about yourselves that others know in a group but you will be unaware of it. Others may interpret yourselves differently than you expect. The blind spot is reduced for an efficient communication through seeking feedback from others.

3. Hidden area or façade – Information that is known to you but will be kept unknown from others. This can be any personal information which you feel reluctant to reveal. This includes feelings, past experiences, fears, secrets etc. we keep some of our feelings and information as private as it affects the relationships and thus the hidden area must be reduced by moving the information to the open areas.

4. Unknown area – The Information which are unaware to yourselves as well as others. This includes the information, feelings, capabilities, talents etc. This can be due to traumatic past experiences or events which can be unknown for a lifetime. The person will be unaware till he discovers his hidden qualities and capabilities or through observation of others. Open communication is also an effective way to decrease the unknown area and thus to communicate effectively.

Example

Linda got a job in an organization. Her co-workers knew a little about her and in this context the unknown and hidden areas will be larger and the open area will be small. As the others don't know much about her the blind spot also will be smaller and the model will be as shown in Figure 1.

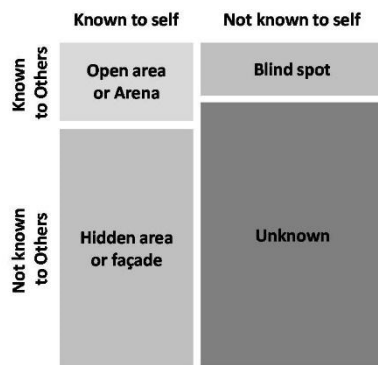


Figure 1

Linda spent most of her free time sketching in the office which was her preferred pastime and her co-workers found her very shy and elusive. With that evaluation she got the idea how she was and tried to be more talkative and interacted more with other co-workers. This helped her to increase her open area and thus making the hidden and unknown areas smaller. (Figure 2)

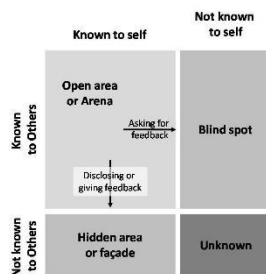


Figure 2

Through the feedback Linda got from her co-workers she could perform well in the office and her real capacity could be obtained as a result of an effective interaction among the colleagues.

SET OF RULES TO BE KEPT IN MIND DURING A PRESENTATION

Discover the Universal Value That Moves Your Audience

Before you write a story for your presentation, find what values are at stake. There are universal values that work for everyone, because deep inside we're all the same. If you find the universal value that moves your audience, you can discover the negatives that cause them stress and anxiety. With this information, you have "gold" in your hands to build your presentation.

Know the Many Facets of Your Audience

The key to understanding an audience is finding the truth about their desires. By finding out what your

audience wants to achieve, you can create a story about a protagonist with the same goal in mind.

.Find a Protagonist and the Worst That Can Happen

When creating a presentation, you need to understand that the audience expects more than a list of topics with a rhetorical narrative. They expect you to surprise them. They expect you to tell a story. All stories are about someone who gets in trouble. So go deep into the conflicts the audience may confront. Then a resolution or a conclusion can come naturally.

Tell the Truth

Typically, presentations avoid problems and emphasize the good. This is the best way to lose your credibility. Everything that sugarcoats your point, leave that at home. The audience trusts in honesty and not in perfection anymore.

Use the Three-Act Structure

Try to make every presentation a three-part narrative:

Act 1 sets up your story

Act 2 contains the obstacles your main character(s) has to resolve and the relationship stories that must be developed

Act 3 ties everything up

Make Sure Your Visuals Are Relevant

PowerPoint is not your enemy. You cannot put the responsibility for a bad presentation onto software that was originally created to help you build “power” into your “point.” To do this, you need to have the story in your mind and use the slides like scenes from a movie. Each one has a purpose. Visuals help stimulate emotion. Visual language makes the message easier to understand. So make your visual choices carefully and ensure that they support the story you are telling

Every Slide Counts

Slides are not “documents.” Slides are not “reports.” They are part of a whole, your presentation. Each slide should deliver one message, then a group of slides together delivers a bigger message called a “sequence.” A group of sequences could be considered as an act. A group of three acts (considering the classical structure) delivers the whole story of your presentation.

Prepare Yourself and Be Relaxed

Every professional needs time to study and practice. If you trust too much in your potential, you can get into big trouble. “I don’t need to train or rehearse. I can improvise if something unplanned arises.” With this attitude, your presentation will be the rehearsal, and you will not unleash your true potential as a presenter.